

The Bylaws of the Student Government Association of Stevens Institute of Technology



Effective: 4 May 2025

Contents

Article I	Formation of Law	5
Section 1.1	Legislation	5
Section 1.2	Origin of a Bill	5
Section 1.3	Structure	5
Section 1.4	Proposition	6
Section 1.5	Sponsorship	6
Section 1.6	Approval	7
Article II	The Senate	8
Section 2.1	Senators	8
Section 2.2	Elections of the Senate	9
Section 2.3	Senate Resignations	10
Section 2.4	Meetings of the Senate	10
Section 2.5	Sessions of the Senate	16
Section 2.6	Standing Motions	17
Section 2.7	Financial Powers	17
Article III	The Cabinet	18
Section 3.1	Presidential Elections	18
Section 3.2	Archiving	18
Section 3.3	Meetings of the Cabinet	18
Section 3.4	SGA Leadership Meetings	18
Section 3.5	Senate Meeting Agendas	18
Section 3.6	Presidential Discretionary Fund	19
Section 3.7	Cabinet and Trustees Meeting	20
Section 3.8	Assistance Vice President(AVP) Positions	20
Article IV	Impeachment	21
Section 4.1	Initial Proceedings Disciplinary Actions	21
Section 4.2	Impeachment Proceedings	22
Section 4.3	Appeal Impeachment Trial	23
Article V	Recognized Student Organizations	24
Section 5.1	Recognized Student Organization	24
Section 5.2	Inactive Organizations	24

Section 5.3	Nonpartisan Funding	25
Section 5.4	Public Forum	25
Section 5.5	Officers and the Executive Board	25
Section 5.6	Financing of Campus Organizations	27
Section 5.7	Votes of Executive Boards	27
Section 5.8	Overruling of Quorum or Voting Membership	27
Section 5.9	Organizational Oversight	28
Article VI	Committees	29
Section 6.1	Types	29
Section 6.2	Chairs	29
Section 6.3	Meetings	29
Section 6.4	Members	30
Section 6.5	Positions	30
Section 6.6	Sub-Committees	30
Section 6.7	Prohibition on Committee Bypass	30
Article VII	Standing Committees	32
Section 7.1	The Committee on Student Interests	32
Section 7.2	Rules Committee	32
Section 7.3	Election Committee	34
Section 7.4	The Campus Life and Improvements Committee	35
Section 7.5	The Academic Affairs Committee	36
Section 7.6	The Senate Budget Committee	36
Section 7.7	Government and Community Relations Committee	36
Section 7.8	Unity, Belonging, Accessibility, Support, and Empowerment (UBASE) Committee	38
Article VIII	Addendums to These Bylaws	40
Section 8.1	Definition	40
Section 8.2	Changes	40
Section 8.3	Ratified Addendums	40
Article IX	Amendments to These Bylaws	41
Article X	Implementation	42
Article XI	Suspension of These Bylaws and Addendums	43
Article XII	Miscellaneous	44
Section 12.1	Written Notice	44
Section 12.2	Campus Improvements and Infrastructure	44
Section 12.3	Headings	45
Section 12.4	Senior Year Activity Allotment	45
Section 12.5	Advertising	45

Section 12.6 Parliamentary Authority	45
Section 12.7 Funded Non-RSOs	46
Section 12.8 Letter from the Stevens Undergraduate Student Body	46
Article XIII Severability	48
Article XIV Powers Reserved to the Senate	49
Article XV Powers Reserved to Recognized Student Organizations	50

Article I. Formation of Law

Section 1.1. Legislation

A. Definition

Legislation is a written proposal brought before the Senate by a Senator to take certain action or adopt, remove, or amend certain policies.

B. Types

Senators can introduce only two types of legislation to the Senate: resolutions and proclamations. A resolution can adjust fund allocations, modify governing documents of the SGA, or it can mandate action of SGA Officers. A proclamation is a decree, declaring an opinion of the Senate; it may address a specific party. Any piece of legislation that is under the consideration of the Senate shall be referred to as a bill. Any passed piece of legislation shall be referred to by its respective type: resolution or proclamation.

Section 1.2. Origin of a Bill

A senator shall submit a bill to the Secretary, who shall place the bill on the docket. A motion to approve the bill must appear on the docket for the Senate to consider the bill. The Senate can approve only bills on the docket.

Section 1.3. Structure

A. General

A piece of legislation shall contain:

- a) a title;
- b) the proposal date
- c) the proposer(s);
- d) the sponsor(s), if any;
- e) the reasons for the legislation, in the form of a “whereas” clauses; and
- f) the intended actions, in the form of “resolved” clauses.

B. Title

The proposer(s) of legislation shall title their legislation in accordance to the following structure:

- i) The type of legislation, either “Proclamation” or “Resolution”;
- ii) An index code with a hyphen (“-”) separating each of the following subitems:
 - a) “S” for Resolution and “P” for Proclamation;
 - b) The last two digits of the current year — i.e. “17” for 2017 — followed by the abbreviation for the semester in which the proposer(s) presents the legislation — i.e. “S” for Spring or “F” for Fall;
 - c) A three-digit ordinal number, incrementing for each bill presented to the Secretary; this number shall be prefixed with zeros to the meet three-digit requirement when necessary — i.e. “005” for the fifth bill introduced into the Senate;
- iii) The phrase “of the”, followed by the current Senate session number, followed by “Senate of the Student Government Association of Stevens Institute of Technology”;
- iv) The name of the legislation, as determined by the proposer(s).

Section 1.4. Proposition

A bill must have at least one proposer. Only senators shall be proposers of a bill. The proposer(s) of a bill should only be those senators who were involved in the drafting, creating, or collaboration of the bill. A Senator may withdraw themselves as a proposer of the bill at any time until voting of approval begins on the bill. A Senator shall not be added to the list of proposers of the bill once legislation has been added to the docket. Should all proposers withdraw support of a bill The Senate may reserve the right with 2/3 majority to approve the bill with “Senate” as the proposer.

If a bill is amended prior to being passed, the proposer(s) of the bill shall be responsible for submitting a final version of the resolution or proclamation to the Secretary for archival.

Section 1.5. Sponsorship

A bill may have a list of sponsors. Any relevant person or entity may be listed as a sponsor of a bill. A sponsor of a bill should only be a person or entity who supports the bill, who has an intimate involvement with the bill, and who consents to sponsoring the bill. A person or entity may withdraw their sponsorship of the bill at any time until voting of approval begins on the bill. A person or entity shall not be added to the list of sponsors of the bill once the bill has been added to the docket.

Section 1.6. Approval

A resolution shall become effective by way of a simple majority affirmative vote of the Senate, while a proclamation shall become effective by way of a two-thirds affirmative vote of the Senate. Both of the aforementioned affirmative vote proportions shall be calculated excluding abstentions. If more than a third of the votes casted are abstentions, then the bill automatically fails to pass. The vote will be by secret-ballot for both types of legislation.

Article II. The Senate

Section 2.1. Senators

A. Definition

Any representative elected by the Student Body to the Senate shall be known as a Senator.

B. Senator Requirements

A Senator will be responsible for meeting the following requirements:

1. A Senator must attend all Meetings of the Senate in a semester, provided, however, that they may accrue up to two absences and two online attendances.
 - a) Any Senator who partially attends a meeting, defined as arriving after the beginning of business or leaving prior to the completion of business, shall accrue half an absence.
 - b) Any Senator who intends to be absent from a meeting shall provide written notice to the Secretary by 24 hours prior to the beginning of the meeting, and the Senator shall only accrue half an absence.
 - c) Any Senator who is absent from a meeting without having provided written notice to the Secretary by 24 hours prior to the beginning of the meeting shall accrue one whole absence.
 - d) Attendance via an online platform, below the limit of two meetings, shall be counted towards quorum. Any online attendance beyond the two meeting limit will be allowed at the discretion of the President.
2. A Senator must either chair one Senate standing committee or sit on at least two Senate committees, at least one of which must be a standing committee, unless otherwise specified. Senators must meet all membership requirements for any committee they sit on.
3. A Senator must work on at least one initiative and pass a monthly Status Update, unless otherwise specified.
 - a) An initiative shall be defined as a goal that benefits the student body.
 - b) The “Status Update” shall consist of:

- i. Evidence that the Senator has completed or attempted to complete their initiative of the current month.
- ii. A declaration of a new initiative or redeclaration of a current initiative for the next month.

4. A Senator must participate in Leadership Training at the discretion of the SGA and the Office of Student Life. Should a Senator wish to attend an alternative leadership session other than those specified, the senator must submit a written description of the event, as well as proof of attendance, to the Oversight Committee.

C. Mandatory Events

Mandatory events are events that are deemed to be essential to the goal of the SGA and require participation from the entire body of the Senate. Shall a Senator or Cabinet member want to consider a specific event mandatory, they shall bring the concern to the Senate a minimum of 3 weeks before the event. Once the concern has been brought up, the person responsible shall provide options for Senator involvement to the Senate a minimum of 2 weeks before the event. The event shall be deemed mandatory by way of $\frac{2}{3}$ majority vote of the Senate.

D. Senator Seat Reorganization

The senate shall ensure that the maximum number of at-large seats are available at all times for vacancy elections. If there shall be a vacant school seat and a current at-large senator falls under that school, the at-large senator shall be immediately reclassified to be a school senator. If there shall be a school senator that switches degree programs into another school, and no school seats are available, the senator shall be reclassified to be an at-large senator. In the event that no at-large seats are available, the senator shall remain as a school representative until reelections or an at-large vacancy occurs by reorganization or resignation. The motion to reclassify the senator shall be stated as “I move to reclassify [“senator name”] from an [“school name or at-large”] senator to a [“school name or at-large”] senator.” The motion requires a second, it shall not be amendable, and it shall not be debatable.

Section 2.2. Elections of the Senate

All provisions and regulations pertaining to Senate Elections and Vacancy Elections are set forth in the Election Procedures and Guidelines, an Addendum to these bylaws.

Section 2.3. Senate Resignations

In order to resign, a Senator must submit a formal resignation to the Secretary and Speaker in written notice. By submitting a formal resignation, a Senator immediately forfeits their Senate seat and shall not be able to resume their position unless elected to the Senate by the Student Body in a general or vacancy election. Once submitted, a formal resignation may not be withdrawn.

Section 2.4. Meetings of the Senate

A. Regular Meeting

While the Senate is in full session, the Senate shall hold one meeting per week. These meetings shall be held on a date and time agreed upon by a majority of the Officials of the SGA and the location shall be communicated in a timely manner before the commencement of the meeting. However, the Speaker, Secretary, or two-thirds of Senators may, in written notice, call a meeting to be held in any other suitable place and at any other suitable time at the Institute that is accessible to the public.

B. Emergency Meetings

The President may call an emergency meeting of the Senate by written notice to the Speaker and the Secretary. In the written notice, the President shall designate the purpose of the emergency meeting, and the intended time and place; no other business shall be considered. The emergency meeting must be held in any suitable place at the Institute that is accessible to the public.

An emergency meeting may also be called by two-thirds of all Senators by written notice to the Speaker, the Secretary, and the President. In the written notice, the Senators shall designate the purpose and the intended time and place of the emergency meeting; no other business shall be considered.

For emergency meetings, the Secretary must prepare agenda and deliver the agenda to all Officials of the SGA at least two hours before the meeting start time; the submission deadline for emergency meetings shall be three hours before the meeting start time. A majority of all Senators, for emergency meetings, shall constitute quorum.

C. Virtual Meeting

The President may call for a virtual meeting in place of an in-person meeting. For virtual meetings, the Secretary must prepare an agenda and deliver the agenda to all Officials of the SGA at least 24 hours prior to the meeting. A simple majority of all Senators, for Virtual Meetings, shall constitute quorum. Emergency Meetings may be held virtually as well, provided they meet all other requirements of Emergency Meetings. Efforts to make a Virtual Meeting open to the public shall be made by the Secretary.

D. Agenda

The Secretary shall prepare an agenda (or “docket”) for each regular meeting, showing the time and place and the business items to be discussed, provided that it adheres to the order of business set forth in these bylaws. The Secretary shall provide a copy of the agenda to all Officials of the SGA in a timely manner before the meeting. For items to be placed on the agenda, an Official of the SGA must submit their bills, communications, memos, discussion items, or any other matters to the Secretary by written notice before the submission deadline. All submissions must be included in the agenda.

E. Submission Deadline

The submission deadline shall be decided upon by the Secretary and must be adhered to for submissions preceding the regular meeting time. However, if the Secretary receives a submission after the deadline has passed, the Secretary shall have the power to decide whether or not the submission will be added to the agenda. If the Secretary adds anything to the agenda after already providing a copy of the agenda to each Official of the SGA, the Secretary must provide an updated agenda for each Official of the SGA, notifying them that it has been updated. The Secretary may not add any new items to the agenda if the start of the meeting will occur within 24 hours.

F. Quorum

Two-thirds of all Senators shall constitute quorum. Quorum must exist for motions to be adopted. If, at any time during a meeting, a Senator raises a question as to the presence of quorum, the Speaker shall forthwith direct the Secretary to count the number of Senators present and shall announce the result, and these proceedings shall be without debate.

G. Speaker

The chair of all meetings of the Senate shall be the Speaker, unless otherwise described by these bylaws. The Speaker shall be elected to a term coinciding with the current session of the Senate. The Speaker shall be elected during the Senate’s first meeting of a new Session. The first order of business during this meeting shall be to elect a Speaker. Until the Speaker is elected, the Vice President of Operations shall be acting Speaker at this meeting. Once a motion to elect a Speaker has been entertained, the Vice-President of Operations shall accept nominations from the floor. Only Senators may nominate a Speaker, and each nomination must be seconded by another Senator. The winning nominee shall, in a vote by secret ballot, accumulate a plurality of the votes of the Senators present. In the event of a tie between the nominees who have accumulated the most votes, the Vice President of Operations shall cast a vote for one of the aforementioned nominees.

If the Speaker resigns, the Senate must hold a vacancy election for a Speaker at the next general meeting. Until a new Speaker is elected, the Speaker pro-tempore shall be acting Speaker of meetings. For the vacancy election, only Senators may nominate a Speaker, and each nomination must be seconded by another Senator. The winning nominee of the vacancy election shall, in a vote by secret ballot, accumulate a plurality of the votes of the Senators present. Upon completion of the vacancy election, the Speaker pro-tempore shall no longer hold the Speaker pro-tempore position, and the new Speaker must appoint a new Speaker pro-tempore.

H. Speaker Pro-tempore

If the Speaker cannot preside over a Senate meeting, the duty shall fall to the Speaker pro-tempore only until the Speaker can preside over the Senate. The Speaker pro-tempore shall be appointed by the Speaker at the first meeting of a new Session of the Senate, and the appointment does not have to be approved by the Senate. The Speaker shall announce the Speaker pro-tempore at the Senate meeting following the latter's appointment. The term for this position coincides with a Session of the Senate. The Speaker pro-tempore must be a Senator.

If the Speaker pro-tempore resigns from this position before the end of the term, then the Speaker must appoint a new Speaker pro-tempore at the next meeting. If the Speaker and Speaker pro-tempore cannot preside over the Senate meeting, the duty shall fall to the Vice-President of Operations.

I. Secretary Pro-tempore

If the Secretary is unable to attend all or part of a Senate meeting, the Secretary pro-tempore from the Senate will fill in to take the minutes for the meeting, or until the Secretary returns. The Secretary pro-tempore shall be appointed by the Secretary, and the appointment does not have to be approved by the Senate. The Secretary shall announce the Secretary pro-tempore at the Senate meeting following the latter's appointment. The term for this position coincides with a Session of the Senate. The Secretary pro-tempore must be a Senator. If the Secretary pro-tempore resigns from this position before the end of the term, then the Secretary must appoint a new Secretary pro-tempore at the next meeting.

If the Secretary and Secretary pro-tempore are unable to attend all or part of the meeting, the duty shall fall to the Vice-President of Operations.

J. Order of Business

All business of the Senate shall be taken up for consideration and disposed in the following order:

1. Call to Order

2. Public Forum

- 237 3. Approval of Minutes
- 238 4. Report from Officials of the SGA
- 239 5. Read Bills
- 240 6. Unread Bills
- 241 7. Other business submitted to the Secretary
- 242 8. New Business
- 243 9. Adjournment

244 Senators shall have the authority to deviate from the order of business as necessary for
245 the efficient conduct of the meeting. However, the Speaker, at their discretion, may
246 refuse to entertain motions that deviate from the order of business, provided that the
247 Senate may override the Speaker's decision by a majority vote.

248 **K. Reading Period**

249 Every piece of legislation shall be subjected to one reading before it may be approved.
250 The approval of a piece of legislation shall not occur in the same meeting as the first
251 reading.

252 1. First Reading

253 The first reading is when a piece of legislation is introduced to the Senate. The first
254 reading shall occur by adopting a motion to read the piece of legislation. The motion
255 to read the piece of legislation shall be stated as "I move to read ["legislation"]." The
256 motion to read a piece of legislation shall have the following characteristics:

- 257 1. It requires a second.
- 258 2. It shall not be amendable.
- 259 3. It shall be debatable. Debate shall last no longer than five minutes, provided,
260 however, that debate may end sooner at the discretion of two-thirds of the Senate.
261 Debate may not be extended.
- 262 4. Adoption of this motion shall not require a vote; instead, adoption of this motion
263 shall occur upon closure of debate.
- 264 5. It shall not be reconsidered.

265 Upon adoption of the motion to read a piece of legislation, the reading period shall begin.
266 Once this period closes, the piece of legislation is considered read, and the Secretary shall
267 place a motion to approve the piece of legislation on the agenda for the following meeting
268 of the Senate.

L. Obtaining the Floor and Debate

1. Rights of the Speaker

If the Speaker is a Senator, the Speaker may move or second even while presiding over the meeting. If the Speaker is not a Senator, the Speaker may not move, second, nor vote.

2. Rights of the Non-Senators

Non-Senators may participate in debate, only when called upon by the Speaker. The Speaker must prioritize debate of Senators over non-Senators, provided, however, the Speaker may choose to call on non-Senators over Senators as necessary for the efficient conduct of the meeting. Non-Senators may not move, second, nor vote.

3. Privilege of Opening Debate

When a Senator makes a motion, that Senator shall, at their discretion, have the privilege of opening debate. The Speaker must call on that Senator once debate begins on a debatable motion.

However, when a Senator moves to approve a bill that they did not propose, that Senator shall not open debate; instead, a proposer of the bill shall, at their discretion, have the privilege of opening debate. The Speaker must call on a proposer of the bill once debate begins on the motion to approve the bill.

4. The Five Minute Rule

The Speaker shall have the power to close debate for any debatable motion and bring the Senate to a vote for the immediate question, provided, however, that the Senate shall be allowed a minimum of five minutes to debate for any debatable motion. The Senate may appeal the Speaker's decision by majority vote.

The Senate may choose to end debate before that five minute period is over by adopting a motion to previous question. However, the motion to previous question shall not be adopted if both (a) five minutes have not passed since debate began, and (b) at least one person votes against the adoption of the motion to previous question.

5. Informality

Any person, having obtained the floor, does not (a) have to begin speaking by addressing the Speaker, nor (b) have to avoid personal references. However, any person, having obtained the floor, must avoid indecorous language.

6. Maximum Time for Each Speech

Any person, having obtained the floor while a debatable motion is immediately pending, shall speak no longer than ten minutes unless obtaining permission from the Senate. Such permission can be given by unanimous consent, or by means of

a motion to extend the limits of debate, which requires a two-thirds vote without debate.

7. Number of Speeches on the Same Question Per Member Per Day

Any person may speak unlimited times for the same question on the same day — except that in the case of a motion to appeal, only the Speaker can speak twice (the second time at the close of debate).

M. One Third Abstention

Should more than one-third of the senators present abstain on a vote of a debatable motion, the Senate shall not adopt that motion.

N. Minutes

The Secretary shall record minutes of all regular and emergency meetings of the Senate showing the time and place; Officials of the SGA present and any non-Official of the SGA present, provided that they speak at least once during the meeting; Officials of the SGA absent and excused; Officials of the SGA absent and unexcused; Officials of the SGA either early or late; all motions made; the results of every vote including the number of yeas, nays, and abstains, provided that the vote was not taken by voice; the vote of each member for every motion, provided that the vote was not taken by voice and was non-secret.

The Secretary must also include transcriptions of all discussion at every meeting of the Senate in the minutes; however, it does not have to be a verbatim record.

Lack of minutes for a particular meeting or part of a meeting will void any action not recorded, provided that there was no bad faith involved.

O. Censure

The Senate may vote to censure a Senator if the Senate deems that the Senator is speaking irresponsibly. A vote of seventy-five percent of the Senate is required.

Should a Senator be censured, they will surrender their right to speak until the business item has been resolved. They shall not lose their right to vote on the business item.

P. Scope

During a period of discussion, should an Official of the SGA, herein referred to as the Scoped Official, make a statement, herein referred to as the Scoped Statement, that a Senator feels is irrelevant to the discussion topic, has already been said multiple times, or is lacking decorum, then the latter Senator may call “Scope” against the Scoped Official. This call shall have the following characteristics:

1. The Senator who called Scope must clarify why they called Scope according to one of the following categories:

- a) Is irrelevant to the discussion topic
- b) Has already been said multiple times
- c) Is lacking decorum (i.e. being rude or disrespectful towards others)

2. It must be seconded by another Senator. Should the Scope fail to be seconded, then the Scope shall fail and discussion shall resume.

3. The Speaker shall affirm or veto the Scope. Their decision shall be the final say on the matter.

If the Scope is adopted, the Scoped Statement shall be formally recognized as “Out of Scope” for the purposes of the Meeting Minutes. However, this shall not preclude the Scoped Official from continuing to speak, including offering new statements that are distinct from the Scoped Statement, provided such statements are not themselves subject to Scope.

Section 2.5. Sessions of the Senate

A. Definition

The session of a particular Senate shall begin at the start of the Senate meeting following the conclusion of Senate elections, and end at the start of the next session of the Senate. A session of the Senate is separate from the parliamentary session, which shall remain defined as the default as adopted from the Senate’s parliamentary authority.

B. Senate Number

Each session of the Senate shall be numbered, beginning with the first session of the Student Council in April 1913. The Senate of the 2024-2025 school year shall be the one-hundred eleventh Senate.

C. Recess

The Senate may declare, by two-thirds resolution, a period in which it shall be considered “in recess.” No business may be conducted nor meetings held by the Senate while it is in recess, except that a meeting may be held to consider a resolution to come back from recess ahead of schedule.

D. Reduced Session

During any period in which either class is not held or less than half of the Student Body is registered for classes, and the Senate is not in recess, the Senate shall be considered to be “in reduced session.” Attendance to any Senate meetings shall not be mandatory during reduced session.

E. Full Session

The Senate shall be considered “in full session,” or simply “in session,” at any time that it is neither in recess nor in reduced session.

Section 2.6. Standing Motions

Standing motions of the Senate may be made by resolution of the majority of the Senate and approval of the President. No standing motion shall be inconsistent with or supersede the bylaws or Constitution of the SGA. Standing motions shall only have effect until the close of the current session of the Senate. No standing motion shall be construed to grant additional powers to recognized organizations or the SGA.

Section 2.7. Financial Powers

The Senate shall have the power to transfer money between SGA accounts and Campus Organization accounts. The Senate may not transfer money out of the Discretionary Fund held by the Cabinet. The Senate shall have the power to spend money out of the main SGA account. However, any motion to spend money must be approved by a simple majority of the Senate where quorum prevails.

Article III. The Cabinet

Section 3.1. Presidential Elections

All provisions and regulations pertaining to Presidential Elections are set forth in the Election Procedures and Guidelines, an Addendum to these bylaws.

Section 3.2. Archiving

The Secretary will oversee the archiving of all writs, resolutions, bills, proclamations, dockets, addendums, and bylaws in the SGA archives. The Secretary will also be responsible for archiving the constitutions, and bylaws of all RSOs, as outlined in [Section 7.2\(E\)](#), and any other material presented to the Cabinet by a duly authorized officer of an organization. These archives will be available to the Student Body electronically.

Section 3.3. Meetings of the Cabinet

The Cabinet shall meet during the constitutionally mandated period. The Cabinet may adopt its own rules for how Cabinet meetings shall run.

Section 3.4. SGA Leadership Meetings

The Cabinet, Committee Chairs, AVPs and all others who hold a leadership role within the SGA shall determine a regular meeting day, time, and location. Any changes must be announced in a timely manner prior to the altered meeting. An SGA Leadership meeting must occur at least once per month after a regular time and date has been determined. The SGA Leadership shall have their own docket for the agendas of these meetings.

Section 3.5. Senate Meeting Agendas

The Secretary will conduct the formation of each and every Senate agenda, referred to as “Docket”. The format will consist of:

1. In order, the following: “Docket for the,” the number of the current session of the Senate, “Senate of the Student Government Association,” and the date of the Senate meeting at which the agenda is addressed.

2. A discussion period referred to as “Public Forum” in which members of the Student Body who are not Officials of the SGA in attendance may discuss items they wish to bring to the attention of the Senate.
3. Reports from any Officials of the SGA who opt in to share updates
4. Committee reports of each committee of the SGA and the reports of any other sub-committees compelled by standing motion of the Senate to be produced at a Senate meeting.
5. Items currently lain on the table by the current session of the Senate.
6. The order of business to be conducted, which shall begin with Old Business and conclude with New Business. Within each of order of business section, the docket will consist of:
 - a) Any bills to be presented to the Senate during the meeting, in the form of a motion to approve the bill with a Senate sponsor of the bill listed as the individual expected, but not required, to make the motion.
 - b) Any other resolutions to be presented to the Senate during the meeting, in the form of a motion to approve the resolution with a Senate sponsor of the resolution listed as the individual expected, but not required, to make the motion.
 - c) Any motions regarding financial items outside of the scope of a resolution, such as approval of a budget or constitution.
 - d) Any business regarding impeachments either brought by a member of the Senate or necessitated by the bylaws.
 - e) An indicator that any other motions will be entertained from the Senate before progressing on to other sections of the order of business.
7. Any other items required to be placed on the Docket by these bylaws or by standing motion of the Senate.
8. A discussion period following the completion of all business during which the Senate, Cabinet, and any other members of the Student Body in attendance may discuss any issues they see fit for discussion at a Senate meeting.

Section 3.6. Presidential Discretionary Fund

There shall be an amount of money reserved every semester, which shall be called the “Presidential Discretionary Fund”. The President shall be authorized to spend money from this fund without the involvement of the Senate. The dollar amount of this fund shall be allocated as ten times the Student Activity Fee.

Section 3.7. Cabinet and Trustees Meeting

The Cabinet shall meet with the trustees defined in Section 2.4.4. of the Amended and Restated Bylaws of the Trustees of the Stevens Institute of Technology, either electronically or in-person. The Secretary shall prepare an agenda for these meetings. At the meeting, the Secretary must record minutes. The Secretary must make these minutes available to the Student Body within seventy-two hours.

Section 3.8. Assistance Vice President(AVP) Positions

A. Purpose

Any member of Cabinet shall have the ability to create Assistant Vice President(AVP) positions. The purpose of having an AVP is for a Cabinet member to offload certain responsibilities onto an AVP or to address a specific need of the SGA that is to be filled by an individual through this position.

B. Creation of an ad hoc AVP role

Once a member of Cabinet has decided that they wish to create an AVP role, they must communicate to the Senate what AVP position they want to create and the responsibilities of the role. The Cabinet member can only offload responsibilities that they themselves have jurisdiction over. The Cabinet member shall also explain the timeline for which the AVP position will exist as any AVP positions created will be ad hoc and thus temporary.

There must be a week's time in between when a member of cabinet announces the ad hoc AVP role they wish to create and the appointment of a person to that role. This is done so that those who wish to express interest in this position have the ability to communicate with that member of Cabinet.

That Cabinet member shall then choose an individual to fulfill this role and two-thirds of Senate vote is required to appoint the candidate to the position. The individual may be a Senator but it is not a requirement. If the candidate is a Senator, their work in that AVP position shall fulfill their Senator requirements.

C. Officializing an ad hoc AVP position

If an AVP position has existed over two complete, consecutive academic calendars, the position must be officialized in the SGA governing documents. This means formally writing in the position and its responsibilities.

The process involves writing a resolution to add the position to the bylaws or affiliated addendum(s) and this process is overseen by the Rules Committee.

When an ad hoc AVP position is officialized, the position shall be recognized as an official of the SgA and the position bearer will no longer be eligible to serve as a Senator while in the position.

Article IV. Impeachment

Section 4.1. Initial Proceedings Disciplinary Actions

Any Official of the SGA may bring concerns to the Oversight Committee in regards to any other Official of the SGA who may be in breach of the governing documents of the SGA. The aforementioned Official of the SGA must receive a written reply from the Oversight Committee acknowledging that their concerns have been heard. The members of Oversight Committee shall view evidence against the accused Official at the next Oversight Committee Meeting. Should the latter be impeached, then the Oversight Committee shall, with a two-thirds majority vote, debate upon one of the following disciplinary actions:

1. Request to Resign

- a) The Oversight Committee shall request via Email that the accused Official resigns from the SGA at the earliest available opportunity.
- b) Should the Official not wish to resign, then they shall follow the procedure outlined in the next listed disciplinary action.
- c) If the Official does not respond to the Email acknowledging that they have seen the Email within 48 hours, then they shall be removed from office

2. Warning/Clarification of Role

- a) The Oversight Committee shall request via Email that the accused Official provides, in written notice, acknowledgment of breaching the government documents of the SGA to all Officials of the SGA along with a notice of how they shall improve themselves.
- b) Upon deliberation by the Oversight Committee after they have received the letter at the next Oversight Committee meeting, the Oversight Committee shall either drop all charges, strip the Official of any special title, or remove the Official from the SGA. Special titles include appointed committee chairs and elected committee membership.
- c) If the Official does not respond to the Email within 48 hours acknowledging that they have seen the Email, then they shall be removed from office.

3. Removal from Office

- a) The accused Official shall be removed from office. Removal from Office removes an Official of the SGA from their Official position(s). This disciplinary action is effective immediately.

517 4. Ban from the SGA

- 518 a) The accused Official shall be removed from their current position and shall
519 be prohibited from holding Office in the SGA ever again. This disciplinary
520 action shall be effective immediately and last forever.

521 If the accused Official is a member of the Oversight Committee, then the latter Oversight
522 Committee member shall not have a vote. The chair must appoint another Senator
523 of that member's school as a pro tem member to vote on that member's disciplinary
524 action. If the accused Official is the Speaker, then the Vice President of Operations shall
525 serve as acting chair of the committee while the Oversight Committee deliberates on a
526 disciplinary action. In this circumstance, the Vice President of Operations may break a
527 tie if the vote to adopt a disciplinary action is divided.

528 **Section 4.2. Impeachment Proceedings**

529 The Oversight Committee shall impeach an Official by adopting the motion "I move to
530 impeach ["Name"]." The motion to impeach shall have the following characteristics:

- 531 1. It can be made only by a member of the Oversight Committee at an Oversight
532 Committee meeting.
- 533 2. It can be made only on an Official of the SGA.
- 534 a) If a member of the Oversight Committee moves to impeach another member of
535 the Oversight Committee, then the latter Oversight Committee member shall
536 not have a vote. The chair must appoint another Senator of that member's
537 school as a pro tem member to vote on that member's impeachment.
- 538 b) If a member of the Oversight Committee moves to impeach the Speaker, then:
- 539 i. The Vice President of Operations shall serve as acting chair of the com-
540 mittee while this motion to impeachment is debated.
- 541 ii. The Vice President of Operations shall break a tie if the vote on the
542 motion to impeach is divided.
- 543 3. It shall not require a second.
- 544 4. It shall not be amendable.
- 545 5. It shall be debatable.
- 546 6. Adoption of this motion shall require a two-thirds majority.

547 Upon completion of the vote, the Oversight Committee impeaches the Official by
548 charging them with breaching the governing documents of the SGA.

Section 4.3. Appeal Impeachment Trial

An Official of the SGA who has been impeached may appeal the decision of the Oversight Committee by trial before the Senate within 48 hours of being notified of their impeachment. The Official must write a formal letter and deliver it to the Speaker and VPO entailing their new goals and how they hope to contribute to the SGA or reasoning as to why they believe their impeachment and/or disciplinary action was not warranted within 48 hours of appealing the decision of the Oversight Committee. Once the letter has been delivered, the Secretary shall include “Impeachment Appeal of [“Name”]” on the agenda for the next Senate meeting. If the letter is delivered within 48 hours of the next Senate meeting, then the Appeal Impeachment shall take place during the following Senate meeting. At the Senate meeting, a motion will be made to discuss the Impeachment Appeal in this format “I move to vote on the Impeachment Appeal of [“Name”]”. This motion shall have the following characteristics:

1. It shall require a second.
2. It shall not be amendable.
3. It shall be debatable.
4. Adoption of this motion shall require a simple majority.
5. Voting will be conducted via a closed form.

The results of the vote shall be effective immediately. Should the Senate approve the Impeachment Appeal, then all Disciplinary Actions levied by the Oversight Committee on the affected individual will be null.

Article V. Recognized Student Organizations

Section 5.1. Recognized Student Organization

A. Definition

A Recognized Student Organization, herein referred to as an “RSO”, shall be defined as a Campus Organization that has obtained recognition from the SGA.

B. The New Organization Process

Any member of the Stevens Institute of Technology undergraduate student body may apply to form a new student organization recognized by both the Office of Undergraduate Student Life and the SGA. This process, found in The New Organization Process, an addendum D to these bylaws, must be followed in order to acquire this recognition.

C. Duration

A Campus Organization shall be considered an RSO during the semester in which it has successfully completed the procedures outlined in The New Organization Process and received full RSO status from the SGA, and any following semesters, even when the Senate is not in full session.

Section 5.2. Inactive Organizations

A. Definition

An Inactive Organization shall be defined as any approved RSO that fails to register with the Cabinet & the Office of Student Life.

B. Determination

If an RSO becomes inactive, the Vice President of Student Interests or the Office of Student Life reserves the right to approach members of the organization, to determine if the organization is still active outside of the auspices of the SGA.

C. Inactive

If the number of voting members required for quorum of the organization cannot be located by the Vice President of Student Interests, or a majority of located voting members do not affirm that the organization is currently active, then the Vice President of Student Interests shall publicize a new emergency election and shall open nominations for a new executive board of the organization.

D. Inactive or Unable to Reorganize

Should the organization affirm it is an active RSO, but a new executive board is not formed, or the new executive board does not meet the requirements for recognition within one week after they take office, the organization shall return all SGA funded items and equipment and become ineligible for recognition by the SGA until it reorganizes following the process outlined in The New Organization Process Addendum to these Bylaws.

Section 5.3. Nonpartisan Funding

No Campus Organization may use SGA-provided funds to promote, except as provided for by the rights of a free press, any candidates for any election. Campus Organizations may promote candidate awareness by providing unbiased information on each candidate, or by promoting every candidate equally.

Section 5.4. Public Forum

The publications and content distribution mechanisms of all organizations shall be considered a “public forum.” Individuals shall be liable for their own statements when conveyed by organizations.

Section 5.5. Officers and the Executive Board

A. Unified Elections

1. Officer Terms Officers of an RSO will serve a term of one-year or until the next Unified Elections, and until their successor is elected, or a lesser term if specified in the RSO’s Constitution. Officers of an RSO will take office immediately following their election, unless otherwise specified in the RSO’s Constitution.

2. Timeline Unified Elections shall occur once every academic year. The first full week of school following the University-defined Spring Recess shall be the Unified Elections period. The last week of school preceding Spring Recess shall be the Unified Nominations period. An RSO must accept officer nominations during the Unified Nominations period,

submit all nominations to the Office of Student Life immediately thereafter, and then hold a special meeting for elections of all officers during the Unified Elections period, in which any ballot cast for an individual whose nomination was not previously approved by the Office of Student Life will be considered invalid.

3. Custom Elections An RSO may define in their Constitution a custom period for their Unified Elections, provided there is at least one week in between the Unified Nominations period and the Unified Elections period, and that the elections process complies with all other rules specified in these bylaws, especially above.

4. Changes Any necessary changes in an RSO's officers outside of the standard Unified Elections period (including RSOs that conduct Unified Elections during a custom time period) may only occur after notification of the Vice President of Student Interests and after verification by the Office of Student Life of any individuals intending to become an officer.

5. Vacancies Unless the RSO's Constitution specified otherwise, when a vacancy in an RSO officer position occurs, a special election process shall be held following the same procedures as Unified Elections, except that the Unified Nominations period will begin the first full week of class following the first meeting after the vacancy exists, and the Unified Elections period will begin the second full week of class following the end of the Unified Nominations period.

B. Executive Board

1. Definition Every RSO will have an Executive Board, consisting only of officers of the RSO, and including all officers of the RSO unless otherwise defined in the RSO's Constitution. Every Executive Board shall consist of at least a President, Vice President, Treasurer, and Secretary or equivalent positions. A majority of the RSO's Executive Board must consist of elected officers.

2. Funding Only a majority of the Executive Board, or higher if specified by the RSO by Constitution, bylaw, or standing rule, shall have the power to authorize spending of the RSO's SGA-allocated funds, provided such spending is in compliance with the RSO's budget as approved by the SGA.

3. Appointed Officers Any officers of an RSO that are not elected by the RSO's general body must be appointed by a majority, or higher if specified by the RSO by Constitution, bylaw, or standing rule, of only those members of the Executive Board who themselves were elected by the RSO's general body.

4. Composition The Executive Board will be composed of at minimum four (4) positions, which shall fulfill, at minimum, the duties of a President, Vice President, Treasurer, and Secretary, as specified in the RSO constitution template. The number of Executive Board positions shall not be limited to the minimum four (4) positions, and organizations may define supplemental Executive Board positions so long as the number of positions does not exceed the lesser of twenty (20) or half of the average attendance of the RSO's past events, calculated by taking the average of the attendance of the past five (5) events per DuckLink. The Vice President of Student Interests and Rules Committee Chair shall be responsible for ensuring compliance with this rule.

Section 5.6. Financing of Campus Organizations

A fund allocation is any amount of money that the Senate transfers between SGA accounts and Campus Organization accounts. The Campus Organization will be responsible for following all policies outlined in The Senate Budget Committee Finance Policy and Guidelines, an Addendum to these bylaws, in order to receive and maintain fund allocations from the SGA.

Section 5.7. Votes of Executive Boards

Any meeting not open to the entire Student Body shall be considered to be held in executive session. The executive board of an RSO may only hold exclusive votes on items that are left to solely its discretion that are outlined in the RSO's constitution. The voting membership of the general body of an RSO shall have the right to vote on all items not left solely to the discretion of its executive board.

Section 5.8. Overruling of Quorum or Voting Membership

Should an RSO become unable to conduct business due to its inability to achieve quorum or the necessary amount of eligible voting members at any of its meetings as a result of an ineffective definition of quorum or voting membership in its constitution or bylaws, the RSO's quorum or definition of voting membership may be temporarily overruled by the Vice President of Student Interests. The Vice President of Student Interests shall mandate a more suitable, temporary definition of quorum or voting membership for the RSO that allows for business to be conducted at its meetings. This temporary definition of quorum or voting membership shall only last until the RSO has voted on the business it initially sought to conduct, amended its definition of quorum or voting membership in its constitution or bylaws to be more suitable, and had any changes to its constitution reviewed by the Rules Committee and approved by the Senate. This process shall not occur unless the RSO submits evidence to the Vice President of Student Interests of

693 having held at least one special meeting designated solely for the purpose of conducting
694 business and having notified the entirety of its voting membership of this meeting at
695 least one week prior.

696 **Section 5.9. Organizational Oversight**

697 The regulations surrounding Organizational Oversight are described in the Committee
698 of Student Interest Regulations and Responsibilities, an Addendum to these bylaws.

Article VI. Committees

Section 6.1. Types

A. Standing Committees

Standing Committees shall be defined as permanent committees of the SGA which shall exist to perform certain duties on an ongoing basis. In order for a committee of the SGA to be classified as a Standing Committee, it must have its name and purpose outlined in [Article VII](#) of these Bylaws. Standing Committees may have further rules and responsibilities outlined in other governing documents of the SGA, such as the Constitution and addendums to these bylaws.

B. Ad Hoc Committees

An Ad Hoc Committee shall be defined as a committee of the SGA which shall exist only temporarily to perform certain duties. No governing documents of the SGA shall refer to any Ad Hoc Committee by name.

Section 6.2. Chairs

Unless otherwise specified in any governing documents of the SGA, each committee shall have one chair, which shall be a Senator, unless specified in [Article VII](#). The chair shall be appointed at the beginning of each session of the Senate, or when a vacancy occurs, as specified in the Constitution of the SGA.

Each committee chair shall track attendance and keep accurate minutes of committee meetings and upload minutes within 24 hours of the meeting. Each committee chair shall participate in a goal setting session with the Vice-President of Operations at the beginning of each semester in order to define the committee's goals for the semester. Each committee chair shall attend two additional one-on-one evaluation sessions with the Vice-President of Operations; one midway through the semester and one at the end of the semester.

Section 6.3. Meetings

Each committee chair shall determine a regular meeting day, time, and location, and any changes must be announced to the Senate in a timely manner before the next committee

meeting. Each committee chair shall inform the Vice-President of Operations of the time, date, and location of regular meetings. Each committee chair must hold a meeting at least once per two week period after a regular time and date has been determined.

The only exception to this rule shall be the Committee on Student Interests.

Section 6.4. Members

Unless otherwise specified in the definition of the body, every committee shall allow any member of the Stevens community to be a member of the committee.

Every Senator, with the exception of the Speaker if they are a Senator, must either chair one Senate standing committee or sit on at least two Senate committees, at least one of which must be a standing committee. Participation on the Election Committee shall not satisfy the standing committee requirement. Senators shall be assigned to Standing Committees by the Vice President of Operations based on each Senator's interest and the need for Senators on each Committee. Senators must meet attendance requirements of each Standing Committee on which they serve as well as perform all duties assigned to them by the Committee Chair, or be eligible for disciplinary action as defined in [Article IV](#).

Section 6.5. Positions

The chair of a committee shall be permitted to create or remove officer positions in the committee at will, and appoint members to those positions, unless otherwise specified in the definition of the committee.

Section 6.6. Sub-Committees

Standing sub-committees shall exist only within the Committee of Student Interests, and are further defined in the Committee of Student Interest Regulations and Responsibilities, an addendum to these bylaws.

Ad-hoc sub-committees may exist at the discretion of the parent committee. The chairs of ad-hoc sub-committees shall be appointed by the chair of their parent committee.

Section 6.7. Prohibition on Committee Bypass

Committees may be charged with various duties otherwise left to the entire Senate, either by the bylaws or by administrative assignment. Committees may also be charged with the duty of prior review before a motion may be presented to the Senate. A motion before the Senate that bypasses these duties of a committee shall not be entertained, unless the committee has already been presented with the issue and has either not

760 resolved it in a timely manner, or has ruled in a manner unacceptable to the person or
761 organization presenting the issue.

Article VII. Standing Committees

Section 7.1. The Committee on Student Interests

The Committee on Student Interests (CSI) shall act as the liaison between Student organizations and officials of the SGA. Furthermore, the CSI shall be responsible for establishing an active communication stream between itself and Student Organizations. The powers, responsibilities, membership, and regulations of the CSI are further described in the Committee of Student Interest Regulations and Responsibilities, an Addendum to these bylaws.

Section 7.2. Rules Committee

A. Purpose

The purpose of the Committee is to ensure the Constitution, Bylaws, and addendums of the SGA remain up to date, as well as serve as a resource for Senators wishing to ensure legislation presented to the Senate is properly written and formatted. The Committee must also be responsible for reviewing the constitutions and bylaws of the various RSOs of Stevens Institute of Technology.

B. Review of RSO Constitutions and Bylaws

The Committee is charged with reviewing any and all constitutions and bylaws of organizations seeking RSO status before they are presented to the Senate, as well as any amendments to an existing RSO's constitution or bylaws approved by its voting membership. The Committee must insist that any presented constitutions be in compliance with the various rules for RSOs defined in [Article V](#), be grammatically correct and coherent, and offer other recommendations to ensure for the longevity of the organization. The Committee must ensure the constitution of an RSO, at minimum, includes the name of the organization, a stated purpose, voting membership requirements, a list of executive board positions and associated responsibilities, a stated election period for officers of the executive board, a definition of quorum, an adoption clause, and a chaos clause.

The Committee must, upon request, assist organizations in creating appropriate bylaws for the governance of their club, and must bring to the Senate's attention any organization's bylaws that the Committee feels is in conflict with the organization's constitution, the Constitution of the SGA, or these bylaws.

Review of RSO governing documents must follow the following procedure:

1. Upon receiving RSO governing documents, any information left out of the original submission will be asked for by a member of the committee.
2. The submitted governing documents will be reviewed and commented on by at least two members of the committee, which will be assigned during the soonest possible Rules Committee meeting.
 - a) If there are no issues or concerns, the documents must move on to committee approval.
 - b) If there are comments, the documents along with comments will be sent back to the original submitter for revisal.
3. Revised documents and documents without raised issues or concerns can be considered for approval through a 2/3 majority vote of the committee where quorum prevails.
 - a) If the vote passes, the governing documents will be considered approved by the Rules Committee, and be sent to the Senate for ratification or denial.
 - b) If the vote fails, the documents will be sent back to the original submitter with comments for further revisal.

C. Review of Governing Documents

The Rules Committee must have a reading of the Constitution of the SGA during the Fall semester and a reading of the Bylaws and Addendums to these Bylaws during the Spring semester. Readings must be completed in a timely manner. If the Committee deems that revisions be necessary to any governing documents of the SGA, the Committee Chair must present at least one bill to the Senate within that semester which must, at a minimum propose revisions which remove any outdated policies and add any new policies not yet codified in each respective document. These bills must be titled "Recommendations of the Rules Committee for the Upkeep of", followed by either "the Constitution of the Student Government Association", "the Bylaws of the Student Government Association", or "the Addendums to the Bylaws of the Student Government Association" followed by "for the", followed by the name of the semester in which the bill is being proposed, followed by "Semester".

D. Review of Legislation

The Committee shall, upon the request of the proposing Senator(s), be charged with reviewing any legislation not yet submitted to the Secretary to be put on the SGA Senate Docket as an Unread Bill. After the first reading period for a piece of legislation closes, the Committee shall review the legislation at their next meeting. The Committee shall ensure that the legislation meets the requirements set forth in **Article I**, is grammatically correct and coherent, does not conflict with the governing documents of the SGA where not intended, and offer other objective assistance to ensure the wording of the legislation is aligned with its purpose.

E. Governing Documents Upkeep and Archival

The Committee shall be responsible for entering all amendments to the governing documents of the Student Government Association made through resolutions passed by the Senate. The Committee shall also assist the Secretary in archiving the governing documents of RSOs, and the governing documents of the Student Government Association. The Rules Committee Chair may make non-substantive changes in spelling, grammar, or numbering to these Bylaws without amendment, provided they must notify the Secretary and all voting members of the Rules Committee of these changes in written notice. The Secretary and voting members of the Rules Committee may object to these changes through written notice to the Committee Chair, and if at least one objection is raised before 24 hours, the non-substantive changes must be reversed.

F. Quorum

Majority of all voting members of the Committee shall constitute quorum. Quorum must be present for motions to be adopted.

G. Voting Membership

Any undergraduate student of the Stevens Institute of Technology is a voting member of the Rules Committee if they have attended four out of the past six regularly-scheduled Rules Committee meetings, or two out of the last four Rules Committee meetings for Officials of the SGA. The Committee Chair is always a voting member.

H. Meetings

All meetings of the Rules Committee require an agenda, which must be sent to the voting members of the Committee at least 24 hours beforehand. This agenda must contain, when applicable, organization constitutions to be reviewed, suggestions for motions to approve revised constitutions, and legislation submitted to the Committee for objective review. Approval of a revised organization constitution requires a two-thirds majority vote where quorum prevails. The Committee Chair shall be the Chair for the meeting, and designate a voting member to take minutes for the meeting.

Section 7.3. Election Committee

A. Purpose

The Committee shall be responsible for administering all active elections for the Cabinet and Senate. Additionally, the Election Committee must organize a debate between the candidates for the Presidential Election. Should no physical location be suitable, Presidential Elections debate may be held virtually. The debates must fall within 2 weeks' time of the end of the nomination period. The election committee shall announce

865 the dates of nomination, dates of elections, and date of the debate to the senate. The
866 senate shall announce these election rules to the student body.

867 **B. Requirements of Committee Members**

868 The term school shall be interpreted as defined by the Constitution of the SGA. In
869 accordance with the Constitution of the SGA, the Secretary shall chair the Election
870 Committee.

871 **C. Conflict of Interest**

872 Should a member of the Student Body run for a Cabinet position, be promised an
873 appointed Cabinet position, or be running for any Senate seat, the person shall become
874 ineligible for membership on the Committee.

875 **D. Improprieties and Errors**

876 Should any candidate fail to abide by the rules and procedures of the elections outlined in
877 The Election Procedures and Guidelines Addendum, the infraction shall be brought up to
878 the Election Committee. Should the Election Committee deem an infraction valid, they
879 shall then decide whether the infraction is Minor or Severe. The Election Committee
880 shall have the right to issue a repercussion listed within the Infraction Repercussion
881 Table. If a desired repercussion strays from the Infraction Repercussion Table then the
882 Election Committee can make a recommendation and only by 3/4 majority, the senate
883 may issue a repercussion that strays from the Infraction Repercussion Table. Consult
884 the Election Procedures and Guidelines Addendum for the possible repercussions.

885 **E. Result Certification**

886 The Committee must certify the results of every election of the Senate or Cabinet.
887 Should the Committee refuse to certify the results, two-thirds of the Senate shall have
888 an opportunity to certify the results by resolution. Should both the Election Committee
889 and the Senate refuse to certify the results, the President shall nominate a member of
890 the student body from each school to certify the results.

891 **Section 7.4. The Campus Life and Improvements** 892 **Committee**

893 **A. Purpose**

894 The purpose of the Campus Life and Improvements Committee shall be to represent
895 the needs of the student body in all mental, physical and sexual health needs, as well
896 as in all non-academic facets which directly affect the quality of life on campus. This

includes, but is not limited to, the residence life of the student body, conditions for commuter students, and the dining services on campus. The committee shall also work collaboratively with the Division of Student Affairs and any university partners that are deemed relevant and necessary at the time. Lastly, the committee will serve as a channel for students to provide their input about a broad range of campus affairs to both the SGA and the administration.

Section 7.5. The Academic Affairs Committee

A. Purpose

The purpose of the Academic Affairs Committee is to represent the academic needs of the Stevens student. Additionally, this committee will promote and uphold the values and rights of the Stevens student under the Stevens Honor System, for all concerns pertaining to academics. Furthermore, this committee shall have members be a part of the committee for student and faculty engagement and report on its affairs to the Student Government Association. This committee shall work collaboratively with the Vice President of Academic Affairs of the Student Government Association, the Stevens Honor Board, and the Office of the Provost.

B. Committee Co-Chairs

The first Co-Chair of the Academic Affairs Committee shall be the Vice President of Academic Affairs of the Student Government Association. The Vice President of Operations with the consultation of the VPAA shall have the authority to appoint the Academic Affairs Committee Senator Co-Chair, which shall be approved by way of two-thirds vote of the Senate.

Section 7.6. The Senate Budget Committee

The purpose, powers, and membership of the Senate Budget Committee are discussed in The Senate Budget Committee Finance Policy and Guidelines, an Addendum to these bylaws.

Section 7.7. Government and Community Relations Committee

A. Purpose

The purpose of this committee is to be a nonpartisan advocacy group that represents the interests of the Student Body in local, state, and federal affairs. Members of this

928 committee must ensure that government and community officials are aware of both the
929 most important issues and the beliefs of the Student Body.

930 **B. Membership**

931 Any undergraduate student of Stevens Institute of Technology is a member of the Com-
932 mittee if they have attended four out of the past six scheduled Committee meetings.
933 A Senator who was assigned to the Committee by the Vice President of Operations is
934 a member of the Committee, provided that they have not been absent — without a
935 reasonable excuse sent, in written notice, to the chair prior to a meeting — to two of
936 the past four scheduled Committee meetings.

937 **C. Official Communication**

938 The Committee may use the following types of official communication:

939 **a. Proclamation**

940 The Committee may release, in written notice, proclamations to certain government
941 and community officials, provided that the proclamations follow the legislative process
942 defined by the Bylaws.

943 **b. Letter Writing Campaign**

944 The Committee, with the approval of at least two-thirds of the Senate present at the
945 Senate meeting, may compel all Senators present at a Senate meeting to (a) write a stan-
946 dardized message determined by the Committee and sign their name on paper or papers
947 provided by the Committee, and (b) write their name and either their personal address
948 or the address of Stevens onto an envelope or envelopes provided by the Committee. A
949 Senator may write their personal address only if it is in the same governmental district
950 as Stevens, as determined by the Committee. The Committee must then put each signed
951 paper into a unique envelope, add the appropriate postage, and put each envelope in a
952 United States Postal Service collection box within a timely manner.

953 **c. E-mail Campaign**

954 The Committee, with the approval of at least two-thirds of the Senate present at the
955 Senate meeting, may compel all Senators to send a standardized email to certain gov-
956 ernment and community officials. All Senators must complete this task within a timely
957 manner.

958 **d. In-person Meeting**

959 The Committee, with the approval of the President, may compel a certain Official or
960 Officials to arrange and/or attend a meeting, hearing, or other in-person event or events

with community and government officials to discuss a particular subject determined by the Committee. The Committee must announce this meeting or meetings at the next Senate meeting. The Senate, with the vote of at least two-thirds of the Senators present at a Senate meeting, may prohibit the Committee from engaging in or arranging a particular meeting.

This list does not preclude other forms of official communication by the Committee. Any other form of official communication that compels action by a Senator or Senators who are not in the Committee must receive approval from at least two-thirds of the Senate present at a Senate meeting.

D. Assurance of Neutrality

Official communication by the Committee must receive approval from a majority of the Senate and the President unless otherwise permitted by the Bylaws.

E. Unofficial Communication

Members of the Committee may communicate with government and community officials in unofficial contexts, as provided to them by the First Amendment. However, a member or members cannot construe any unofficial communication to be representative of the beliefs of the Committee, the Student Government Association, or the Student Body.

F. Time-sensitive Matters

Official communication may occur by the Committee without the approval of a majority of the Senate and/or President, provided that all members of the Committee vote to deem that a matter is both time-sensitive and requires official communication before the next meeting of the Senate. The chair of the Committee must notify, in written notice, all Officials of any unapproved official communication within 72 hours.

Section 7.8. Unity, Belonging, Accessibility, Support, and Empowerment (UBASE) Committee

A. Purpose

The purpose of the Committee shall be to represent the needs and concerns of the various identities within the Stevens Student Body, as well as to serve as an outlet for advocacy, activism, and education in relation to unity, belonging, accessibility, support, and empowerment. The Committee shall work with The Office of Student Culture and Belonging, Student Affairs, and any other related offices/organizations to ensure that the needs of underrepresented students are being addressed, as well as to ensure Stevens Institute of Technology maintains an inclusive environment of the entire Stevens Community. They will be open to serve the need of any identity or group of identity

995 on campus, and empower these identities through deep understandings of equity and
996 inclusion and the cultivation of safe(r) spaces for all.

997 **B. Chairperson**

998 The chairperson of the UBASE Committee must be a senator. The Chairperson shall
999 function as a point of contact for the UBASE Committee.

1000 **C. General Committee Body**

1001 The committee shall be composed of a Chairperson elected by the Senate and a group
1002 of Committee Members. The positions may be filled by a senator or non-senator based
1003 upon the Chairperson's discretion.

1004 1. Committee Members

1005 a) Purpose: The role of the Committee Members shall be to further conversa-
1006 tion around identities shared amongst campus. They will push for advocacy,
1007 activism, education, and a more inclusive campus environment. To meet the
1008 needs of the Stevens Community, the Chairperson shall decide what lenses
1009 should be prioritized to serve the current needs of students.

1010 b) Responsibilities: The Members shall execute duties as delegated to the Com-
1011 mittee from the various offices, organizations, and community members of
1012 their respective initiatives, the Chairperson, or their own initiative. They
1013 shall also encourage all the offices, organizations, and community members
1014 on campus to foster a more inclusive campus environment. They will serve as
1015 the point of contact for any initiatives from the UBASE Committee and shall
1016 also aid the committee as a whole in pursuing broad initiatives in relation to
1017 UBASE principles. The members should be able to report on the initiatives
1018 they are pursuing at each committee meeting.

Article VIII. Addendums to These Bylaws

Section 8.1. Definition

An addendum is any supplementary policy or set of policies adopted by the Senate that is to exist separate from the Constitution of the SGA and these Bylaws. An addendum is a governing document of the SGA. No addendum may supersede or be inconsistent with the Constitution of the SGA or these Bylaws.

Section 8.2. Changes

An addendum must be adopted, amended, or removed after the procedure for passing a bill is followed. A bill introducing an addendum is out of order if the title of the addendum is not added to **Section 8.3** Ratified Addendums. An addendum to these Bylaws is only effective if listed in **Section 8.3**, and conversely, an addendum not listed in **Section 8.3** is not effective.

Section 8.3. Ratified Addendums

The following addendums are currently effective by ratification of these Bylaws:

1. Addendum A: Student Government Association Board of Advisors
2. Addendum B: Oversight Committee Guidelines
3. Addendum C: Committee Chairs Expectations
4. Addendum D: The Committee of Student Interest Regulations and Responsibilities (CSIRR)
5. Addendum E: The New Organization Process
6. Addendum F: The Senate Budget Committee Finance Policy and Guidelines
7. Addendum G: Election Procedures and Guidelines
8. Addendum H: The Presidents Council

1043 **Article IX. Amendments to These**
1044 **Bylaws**

1045 Amendments to these bylaws shall occur after the procedure for passing a bill is followed.

Article X. Implementation

Upon ratification of these bylaws, all standing committees and sub-committees will be organized as described in these bylaws. These bylaws shall take effect immediately after ratification and all further items of business at that Senate meeting shall follow these bylaws.

Article XI. Suspension of These Bylaws and Addendums

The motion to suspend any bylaws will have the same characteristics and rules as the motion to suspend the rules in Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised, except that this motion shall be debatable, can only suspend these Bylaws and addendums to these Bylaws, and requires a two-thirds vote of the entire membership of the Senate. Article VIII, Article IX, Article X, Article XI, Article XIII, Article XIV, and Article XV of these bylaws may never be suspended. The motion to suspend the bylaws cannot be used to suspend any other governing document. Any suspension of the bylaws shall only last until the end of the Senate meeting.

Article XII. Miscellaneous

Section 12.1. Written Notice

Only a message sent from a Stevens-issued email account or other previously agreed upon correspondence method shall satisfy any provision requiring written notice.

Section 12.2. Campus Improvements and Infrastructure

There shall exist a Campus Improvements Fund whose sole purpose shall be to finance capital expenditures benefiting the campus. A student, faculty member, staff member, or a group composed of anyone thereof, shall be eligible to access this Fund, after going through the application process outlined below.

A. Initial request period: An initial request, providing a general description of the desired improvement and an anticipated timeline for its completion, shall be made through a DuckLink form. Once the request is submitted, the VPF, AVPF and Senator Co-Chair of the Budget Committee shall meet with the applicant(s) to obtain any further information necessary. The VPF, AVPF and Senator Co-Chair will then vote on whether to move forward to the next step in the process. If they vote no, the VPF, AVPF and Senator Co-Chair shall provide feedback and suggestions to work further on the initial planning stages of the request, at their discretion.

B. Budget Committee Review: If the campus improvements application moves past the initial request stage, the applicants shall be invited to the next Budget Committee Meeting when it is feasible to hold a discussion of the request as an agenda item. At this meeting, the applicants shall receive questions and feedback from the Budget Committee. The Budget Committee shall assess a variety of factors in considering the request, including, but not limited to, how quantifiable from a financial perspective the request is or can be made; how itemized the specific materials or services needed to complete the improvement are or can be made in the request; and whether the anticipated timeline is reasonable. After questioning and discussion, the Budget Committee shall vote by simple majority to move forward with the request.

C. Senate Review and Approval: After the Budget Committee votes to move the request forward, the applicants shall be invited to a Senate meeting to present the request. The Senate shall vote by a simple majority to approve the proposal

for the campus improvement. If the proposal is not approved, the applicants may work further with the Budget Committee to amend the request and submit a new proposal for the Senate to hear.

At least three percent of the total amount of student activity fees rolled back to the SGA at the end of the most recent semester shall be saved for the Campus Improvements Fund. However, if the Campus Improvements Fund has accumulated more than fifty percent of the Student Activities Fund from the most recent fall semester, only two percent of the rolled-back fees shall be diverted to the Campus Improvements Fund, unless the Senate passes a standing motion to the contrary.

Section 12.3. Headings

The heading under which text falls, such as section title or article name, shall not bound the effect of that content.

Section 12.4. Senior Year Activity Allotment

Five percent of the student activity fees of each class year, as defined by the Constitution of the SGA, shall be set aside into senior year activities accounts bound to the graduating class from which the fees were collected. This account shall be unavailable for expenditure until the class year to which it is bound enters its senior year. The Senior Year Activity Committee, by a vote of two-thirds of committee quorum, shall have the power to spend from the account once the account's bound year enters its senior year.

Section 12.5. Advertising

The SGA shall be responsible for informing the Student Body of all campus initiatives and for assisting all SOs in publicizing their events. The SGA shall fund flyer requests for all RSOs. Any additional advertising requests must be approved by the Senate. Printing flyers for any event not open to the entire student body may not be permitted unless approved by the senate.

Section 12.6. Parliamentary Authority

The rules contained in the current edition of Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised shall serve as the parliamentary authority for the SGA in which they are not inconsistent with the Constitution, these bylaws, and any special rules of order the Senate may adopt.

Section 12.7. Funded Non-RSOs

A student organization that is not an RSO shall not be able to request funding from the SGA unless they are approved as a funded non-RSO and meet the requirements outlined in the Senate Budget Committee Financial Policy.

Section 12.8. Letter from the Stevens Undergraduate Student Body

Should an undergraduate student wish to send a written letter to an office or administrator on Stevens Institute of Technology campus, they are permitted to do so via a Letter from the Stevens Undergraduate Student Body. This process is not to be voted on by the Senate, but it is to be administered by the Secretary. The process to create a Letter from the Stevens Undergraduate Student Body is as follows:

1. A formal request to create a Letter from the Stevens Undergraduate Student Body must be submitted to the Secretary via email.
 - a) The aforementioned request must be initiated by a Stevens Undergraduate Student
 - b) The aforementioned request must include a document in its final state with the contents of the letter that is intended to be delivered to its recipient
 - c) The aforementioned request must include the name(s) of the intended recipient(s), the name of the proposing student(s), and a formal title for the letter
2. The Secretary must present the provided details of this letter to the Senate in no more than 2 Senate meetings after the request was submitted
3. Once the Senate has been notified of the details of the submitted request, then the Secretary must open the voting period for this request
 - a) The voting period shall last 2 weeks
 - b) A digital form must be created by the Secretary at the start of the voting period, and sent to the initiating student no later than the first day of the voting period
 - c) The voting form must be opened on the first day of the voting period and shall not close until the voting period has ended
 - d) Votes shall be validated by the Secretary and certified by a simple majority vote of the Election Committee
4. A minimum of 10 percent of the Stevens Undergraduate Student Body must vote using the aforementioned form for the vote to be considered valid

- 1156 a) A minimum of two-thirds of cast votes must be in the affirmative for the letter
1157 to pass, and thus be delivered to its intended recipient
- 1158 b) Should less than 10 percent of the Stevens Undergraduate Student Body vote
1159 using the aforementioned form, or should more than one-third of cast votes
1160 be cast in the opposition, then the letter shall not be delivered to its intended
1161 recipient(s)
- 1162 5. If the vote passes, then the details of the vote shall be included alongside the letter
1163 and the Secretary is to deliver the letter to its intended recipient(s) within 2 weeks
1164 of the closure of the vote. The President is not allowed to sign this letter nor is
1165 the Senate allowed to vote on this letter.

Article XIII. Severability

If a court of competent jurisdiction deems any provision of these bylaws unenforceable, that provision will be enforced to the maximum extent permissible, and remaining provisions will remain in full force and effect.

Article XIV. Powers Reserved to the Senate

The Senate shall have the power to carry forth acts when explicitly permitted by these bylaws. Any further actions shall require amendment to these bylaws to permit these acts.

1175 **Article XV. Powers Reserved to**
1176 **Recognized Student**
1177 **Organizations**

1178 Any powers not explicitly reserved in these bylaws for the Senate and not explicitly
1179 banned in these bylaws shall be reserved to the Recognized Student Organizations.